🦬 Day 3: Settlers and the Homestead Act: Daily Notes · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 2 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · The Heartland

Name: _____

🎯 *Today: How settlers lived on the Plains and the good and bad effects of expansion.*

🔁 Warm-up (5-minute review)

1. Plains settlers burned dried buffalo and cow dung (“chips”) because…
there were few trees for firewood

Key terms: chips · Homestead Act · land rush · sod · windmills

📝 Guided notes

1. The **Homestead Act** (1862) gave 160 acres to settlers who farmed it for 5 years.
2. With few trees, settlers built **sod** houses from dirt and grass.
3. They burned buffalo and cow “**chips**” for fuel.
4. In the 1889 Oklahoma **land rush**, people raced to claim land.
5. Steel plows and **windmills** helped farmers on the dry Plains.
6. Many homesteads were on land taken from **Native nations**.
7. Black settlers called **Exodusters** moved to Kansas for freedom and land.

✍️ Analyze

1. List two positive and two negative effects of westward expansion.
Positive: farms, towns, railroads, opportunity. Negative: Native land loss and wars, buffalo killed, hard life, broken treaties.

🎟️ Exit ticket

1. The Homestead Act gave settlers…

A. a car | B. a paycheck | **C. free land if they farmed it**

2. List two positive and two negative impacts of westward expansion.
See the analyze answer.

🔑 *Key written by our team, please check.*